

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Do you have an eye for design and illustrations?



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Has someone disliked your work before? How did you feel?
- If you had to critically analyze someone's illustrations, what would you say? How would you start?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss reasons and results of an event or action related to work and jobs.
- I can talk about art.
- I can express my opinion.





Let's Explore!

Denise receives a copy of the illustrations; she has some concerns.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Denise:** Kristi, have you seen these illustrations?
- Kristi:** No, I haven't. How are they?
- Denise:** As far as I'm concerned, it's just not that aesthetically pleasing.
- Kristi:** Hmm, I see what you mean. Because there isn't a balance between the visuals and the white space on the page, it comes off as unappealing.
- Denise:** I'm convinced it's the contour lines that lack definition; therefore, it's not that noticeable. What I think needs to happen is that these lines need to be darkened.
- Kristi:** I disagree. Since there is a lot of white space on the page, they don't pop out. If we reduce the white space, it should be fine.
- Denise:** You think so?
- Kristi:** I'm convinced that's the case.
- Denise:** I'll take your word for it, Kristi.
- Kristi:** Now that we're done with that, we can schedule a meeting with the illustrator.
- Denise:** We also need to discuss the typeface. I'm of the opinion that this typeface needs to be changed.
- Kristi:** Personally, I don't see an issue ... However, since this a children's book, it might be a good idea.
- Denise:** I'm glad we're on the same page. This typeface needs to be more kid-friendly. I read somewhere that children's text ought to be warm and friendly design -- simple, with large letter shapes. The contours need to be round and open, not angular or rectangular.
- Kristi:** That makes a lot of sense. Because children are learning to read, the typefaces used should be inviting and easy-to-read.
- Denise:** To my way of thinking, the text needs to be larger. Perhaps 20 to 24 point, depending on the typeface we choose. And on this page, I think we should avoid all caps.
- We'll discuss this further ... I really need to take this call. Since we know what we need to talk about, why don't you contact the illustrator and get him to come in this afternoon?
- Kristi:** Alright. I'm on it.
- Denise:** Hello.



Let's Practice!

These two industry professionals are perplexed by some of the illustrators choices.
 **"To be perplexed"* means confused and bewildered.

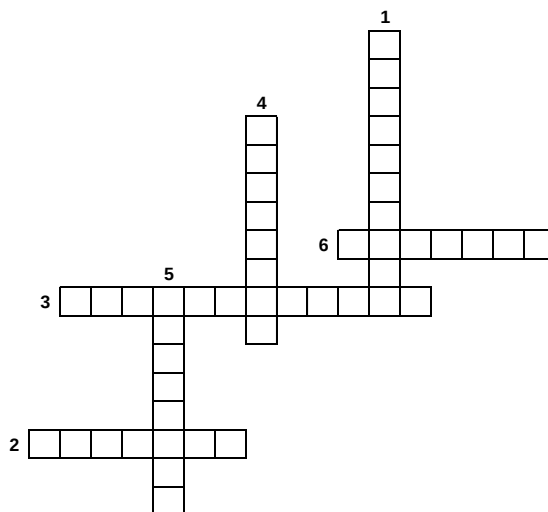
Instructions: Read the clues. What is each sentence referring to? Complete the crossword.

Down

1. There is too much white space on the page.
4. The contours should be round and open, not angular or rectangular.
5. I'm of the opinion that this typeface needs to be changed.

Across

2. The visuals are all wrong.
3. I'm convinced that these contours lines aren't well defined.
6. Because there isn't a balance on the page.



Let's Practice!

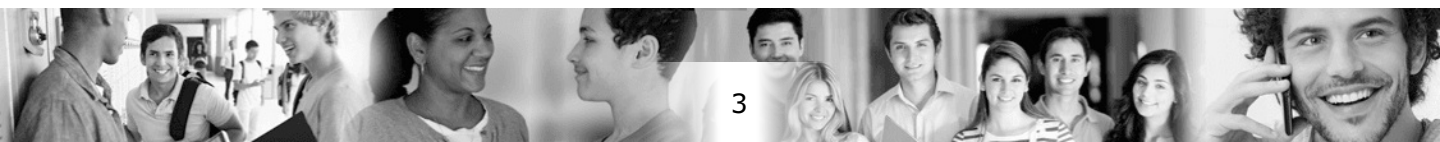
There are some strong opinions about the illustrations.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the correct words from the Word Bank.

Word Bank

my way of thinking / convinced / as I'm concerned / of the opinion / What I think

1. As far _____, these contour lines aren't well defined and therefore not as noticeable.
2. _____ needs to be happen is for them to be darkened.
3. I'm _____ that's the case.
4. I'm _____ that this typeface has got to be changed.
5. To _____, the text should be larger.





Extension Activity

Guess the Picture.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find 5 different images of objects. These images must be vague and taken from an angle that doesn't show the entire object.
- Go to a website like Playbuzz for ideas about the types of images you should get. Do not choose only these images.
- Save the chosen images on your phone/computer or print them out.
- Show the pictures to your class.
- Discuss what you think the images are and explain why you think that.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I go online to find vague images.

☐
☐

I save the images to show my class.

☐
☐

I present the images to my class.

☐
☐

I discuss what the images represent.

☐
☐

I explain my reasons.

☐
☐


Target Words

- aesthetically pleasing** (adjective): beautiful; tasteful
e.g. As far as I'm concerned, the illustrations just aren't that aesthetically pleasing.
- balance** (noun): a condition in which different elements are equal or in the correct proportions
e.g. Because there isn't a balance on the page.
- visuals** (noun): pictures of graphics used to illustrate or accompany something
e.g. The visuals are all wrong.
- white space** (noun): the portion of a page left unmarked
e.g. There is too much white space on the page.
- darkened** (adjective): blackened
e.g. What I think needs to happen is for them to be darkened.
- contour lines** (noun): lines which define a form or an edge
e.g. I'm convinced that these contour lines aren't well defined.
- typeface** (noun): the style of letters used in printed material
e.g. I'm of the opinion that this typeface has got to be changed.





Learning Points

Reason Clauses

When you want to be more precise about the reason for things, you can use linking words to introduce reason clauses.

Refer to the chart for a summary of different words/phrases you can use with reason clauses and their meanings.

Word/Phrase	Meaning/Use	Example
because	the most common conjunction, answering the question <i>Why?</i> can come at the beginning of the sentence, or in between the two clauses	<i>Because</i> there isn't a balance between the visuals and the white space on the page, it comes off looking not so appealing.
since	introduces a reason that the listener is already familiar with	<i>Since</i> there is a lot of white space on the page, they don't pop out.
now that	used in very formal or literary contexts	<i>Now that</i> we're done with that, we can schedule a meeting with the illustrator.





Learning Points

Verbs and Structures to Express Opinion

You can use certain phrases and structures to express your opinion in a variety of ways. Expressing yourself in a polite and clear way is an important part of business conduct.

Here are some effective phrases you can use to express your opinion:

I'm convinced that ...

I'm of the opinion that ...

As far as I'm concerned, ...

To my way of thinking, ...

What I think is that ...

For example:

As far as I'm concerned, the illustrations just aren't that aesthetically pleasing.

Examples:

- ***I'm convinced that*** these contour lines aren't well defined and therefore not as noticeable.
- ***What I think*** needs to be happen is for them to be darkened.
- ***I'm convinced*** that's the case.
- ***I'm of the opinion that*** this typeface has got to be changed.
- ***To my way of thinking***, the text should be larger.
- ***I think*** we should avoid the all caps.

